

Unpublished Basin of ;st- Nwb from Giza

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"حوض ;st- Nwb غير المنشور من الجيزة"

Gh. Azzam

Lecturer, Egyptology Department- Faculty of Archaeology- Cairo University

ghada_azzam@yahoo.com

Hayam Hafez Rawash

Prof. of Egyptology, Faculty of Archaeology, Cairo University

hhafez762@gmail.com

Nagdy, M.

Lecturer, Egyptology Department- Faculty of Archaeology- Cairo University

nagdy2050@yahoo.com

Abstract:

This article studies an unpublished inscribed offering. Basin now preserved in the Faculty of Archaeology Museum, Cairo University, and inventory number 1672. Selim Hassan discovered this basin at Giza, central field, and find spot: S 89, and the location of this shaft is unknown now. This offering basin belongs to ;st- Nwb and her son PtH- Spss. It is made of white limestone, rectangular in shape with two semi-equal rectangular depressions that gradually incline from top to bottom. The two holes are designated for liquid offerings such as water and wine. Two hieroglyphs' lines are carved in sunken relief around the rim of the basin, illustrating the formula of Htp di nsw

It most probably dated to the Old Kingdom, based mainly on some epigraphical details. The text of the basin contains an offering formula addressed to Anubis followed by the name and the title of the owner and that of her son. Some feasts are mentioned as occasions for receiving offerings.

Keywords: Htp di nsw, Offering basins, Giza , The Old kingdom, smdt

المخلص:

تتناول هذه المقالة دراسة حوض قرابين غير منشور، محفوظ الآن في متحف كلية الآثار- جامعة القاهرة، تحت رقم 1672. وقد أكتشف سليم حسن هذا الحوض في الجيزة في وسط الموقع، في البئر رقم S 89 وموقع هذا البئر غير معروف الآن. وينتمي هذا الحوض إلى @st- nwb وابنها PtH- Spss وهو منحوت من الحجر الجيري الأبيض ذو شكل مستطيل، ويضم فجوتين مستطيلتين متشابهتين ويقل اتساعهما بالاتجاه إلى أسفل. وقد خصصت الفجوتين للقرابين السائلة مثل الماء والنبيد. وقد نقش سطرين من الكتابة الهيروغليفية بنقش غائر حول حافة الحوض، يوضحان صيغة Htp- di- nsw.

يعود تاريخه على الأرجح إلى عصر الدولة القديمة بناءً على بعض التفاصيل الكتابية، يحتوى نص الحوض على صيغة قرابين موجهة إلى أنوبيس متبوعة باسم ولقب صاحبة الحوض واسم ابنها، وذكرت بعض الأعياد كمناسبات لتلقى القرابين.

الكلمات الدالة: Hp di nsw، أحوض القرابين ، الجيزة ، الدولة القديمة ، smdt

Introduction

This research aims to study and publish the offering basin of  jst- Nwb¹ and her son  PtH- Spss which preserved at the Faculty of Archaeology Museum, Giza, Egypt under no.1672 (Fig.1). This basin must have been used to present liquid offerings to the owner of the basin, whose name is jst- Nwb “She who is praised of Gold,” which is comparable to masculine examples such as Hsy Ra and by the feminine Hsy-PtH where the masculine name of the god precludes².

The research presents a complete publication by describing the scene on the basin, translating the accompanied texts and giving comments from an artistic and linguistic point of view.

The offering tables and libation basins were the two main objects of cult monuments such as temples and tombs. They were placed on the floor or lowered into the ground in front of the cultic niche in the old kingdom tombs. Libation basins had many practical, religious and symbolic meanings. They were used to hold water used for cleaning the offering place at the beginning of the funerary rituals and also as containers for liquid offerings left over from the rituals (wine, beer, milk, etc.), or as washing basins for the priests. During the Fifth Dynasty, basins obtained its cultic meaning, simply to ensure the food supply of the deceased in afterlife.³

Acting as an impactful point of interaction between the dead and living, offering formulas are usually inscribed on the most publicly accessible parts of the tomb. It is a declaration of glorification and a statement of royal and divine endorsement. A means by which the deceased not only ensured the flow of offerings and performance of funerary rites but which also, according to Allen, documented the royal/divine permission to the deceased to have his tomb built, to be buried in it and to exist together with his funerary property in the realm of the afterlife⁴.

¹ The Old Kingdom theophoric names containing Hsi, given the fact that this verb involve a quite different relationship between men and the gods: Hsi refers to praise, in the sense of commendation of someone, by the gods, in the sense of worship by someone, of the gods.

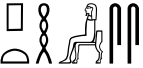
² *PN I*, 191 (26); also an offering basin in Cairo: T 19/ 6/46/1 (*PM III 2*, p. 293); *PN I*, 255 (3).

³ Hölzl, R., “Libation Basins from the Old to the New Kingdom: Practical use and religious significance”, in: *Amenta, A., Luiselli, M.M., and Sordi, M. N.* (eds.), *L’acqua Nell’antico Egitto: Proceedings of the first international Conference for young Egyptologists*, Vol. III, Roma, 2005; pp. 309- 10.

⁴ See Chauvet, V. *The Conception of Private Tombs in the Late Old Kingdom*, PhD dissertation, Johns Hopkins University, Baltimore, 2004.Ch. III.4; Van Walsem, R. *Iconography of Old Kingdom Private Elite Tombs*, *Mémoires de la Société d’Etudes*

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Description:

- **Owner of the Basin:**  ;st- Nwb and her son  PtH- Spss
- **Inventory number:** 1672
- **Location:** The Faculty of Archaeology Museum, Cairo University, Egyptology Department.
- **Date:** Old Kingdom, The Fifth Dynasty⁵
- **Material:** limestone
- **Provence:** Giza
- **Dimensions:** Height 16 cm, width 48.5 cm and length 61 cm.
- **State of preservation:** The Libation basin is almost intact, with only a very small surface damage of the bottom left-hand corner. And it is in a well state of preservation.

Rectangular limestone libation basin with double deep central depressions. There are two rows of inscriptions carved on the rim of the libation basins ending with the name and title of the owner. One row is incised on the upper part and the other row is on the lower part of the libation basin. There are two figures carved on both sides of the basins, the left figure is for the owner who depicted with a long tightened dress, long wig, her right arm is placed beside her while her left hand is placed on her chest. The right figure is for the son of the owner, who depicted naked, putting his finger in his mouth (without the child hair side lock), and his left arm is placed beside him. His name and his relation as a son of the owner are carved before him.

Basins from the Old Kingdom have a deep cent depression and are rectangular in shape. Usually, inscriptions are carved on the thin step as well as the rim of the libation tank. The basins' interior. It was not required to treat the outside of the libation basins with the same care as the rim and the inside because they were frequently buried in the ground. However, there are also instances where the property's sloping exterior was made smooth.⁶

Orientalia 'Ex Oriente Lux' 35, Leiden: Peeters, 2005, , 278; Barta, W., 'Opferliste', in *LÄ IV*, cols. 1982, 584–586;; Franke The Middle Kingdom Offering Formulas – a Challenge', *JEA* 89, 2003, 39–57; Lapp, G. Die Opferformel des Alten Reiches, unter Berücksichtigung einiger späterer Formen, *SDAIK* 21, Mainz: 1986.

⁵ Brunner, H., "Der Bekannte des Königs", *SÄK I*, Hamburg, 1974, p. 58.

⁶ Hölzl, R., "Libation Basins from the Old to the New Kingdom: Practical use and religious significance", in: *Amenta, A., Luiselli, M.M., and Sordi, M. N.* (eds.), *L'acqua Nell'antico Egitto: Proceedings of the first international Conference for young Egyptologists*, Vol. III, Roma, 2005; 311.

Texts

The upper one:



Htp di nsw Inpw xnty sH nTr qrst m Xrt nTr rxt nsw @st- nwb

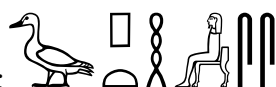
“An offering which the King gives (to) Anubis, who is in front of divine shrine in the necropolis. The king’s acquaintance @st-nwb”⁷.

The lower one:



Prt - xrw t Hnkt n.s m tpy Abd tpy smdt m Hb nb ra nb rxt nsw @st- nwb

An offering (of) bread and beer for her in the festivals of the beginning of the month, of the half-month (15th day) and in every festival every day. The king’s acquaintance @st Nwb.



Text beside her son: sA (.s) PtH- Spss “Her son PtH- Spss”.

Discussions:

(a) *Htp-di-nsw* is a formula by which the various kinds of offerings could be brought to the deceased person to maintain his precious strength and vital power in the afterlife. See This formula should be read as "an offering that the king has given and that Osiris or Anubis or both have given", rather than "an offering that the king has given to Osiris / Anubis " since this dedication does not indicate that the gift was given by the king himself, but rather that the funeral offering was approved by the king. Since the king was seen as a conduit between people and gods, the offering was made in his honor. According to the reversion of offering tradition, the gods are still the ones who make the offerings.⁸

⁷ Brunner, H., ““Der Bekannte des Königs”, p. 55-60.

⁸ Satzinger, H., “Beobachtungen zur Opferformel: Theorie and Praxis”, in: *Ling Aeg* 5, 1997 ,p.177-188; Gardiner, A.H., *Egyptian Grammer*, 3rd Edition, London,1973 ,p.170; Franke, D., “The Middle Kingdom offering formulas: A Challenge ”, p.39-57; Stefanovic, D., *The Late Middle Kingdom stela of the staff of provisioning sector (Sna) (Musées d'art et d'histoire, Genève 6875) ”*, *SÄK* 39,2010, p.314; Collier, M., *How to Read Egyptian Hieroglyphs*.

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In the ancient Egyptian language a number of words are used to designate offering, the most common being Htp⁹, which appears in the texts of the Old Kingdom¹⁰.

The offering formula¹¹ used here on the above side is the normal form of the ancient Egyptians offering formula used during the Old Kingdom, the earlier arrangement of the offering formula Htp-dj-nsw. This was used until at least the start of the 13th dynasty, although the order is often changed for aesthetic reasons by arranging the two tall signs adjacent to each other. According to Satzinger, this is the complete formula.¹²

(b) prt-xrw “verbal offerings”. In most cases prt xrw is followed either by a stated event or place, rarely by both; on our basin prt xrw is followed by an event, festivals. In these cases prt xrw is always followed by the preposition m, as in our case.

(c) “t” : Bread was an essential element of the meal for the living and as offerings for the deceased to support his life during the hereafter, and it is one of the main foods that kings and individuals were keen to have among their offerings from the earliest historical times until the Ptolemaic and Roman periods¹³.

Bread is made in its various forms and types from barley and wheat flour¹⁴ by a group of skilled bakers who manufacture it according to special specifications indicated in the texts when discussing the quantities of flour and dough for bakeries, which determined with extreme precision the sizes and quantities of loaves required¹⁵.

London, University of California Press. 1998, pp.35–39; Lapp, G., „Eine spezielle Opferformel des Mittleren Reiches”, *SÄK* 14, 1987, p. 181 ff.

⁹ *Wb* III, 183; Hannig, R. *Großes Handwörterbuch*, 567.

¹⁰ For more discussion of offering formula see Lapp, G., *Die Opferformel des Alten Reiches*, Deutsches Archäologisches Institut Abteilung Kairo, *Sonderschrift* 21, Mainz, 1986; Barta, W., *Aufbau und Bedeutung der ägyptischen Opferformel*, Glückstadt, 1968.

¹¹ For the offering formula in general and its development during the Old Kingdom in particular

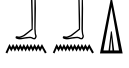
cf. W. Barta, *Aufbau und Bedeutung der altägyptischen Opferformel*, *ÄF* 24 (Glückstadt, 1968); G. Lapp, *Die Opferformel des Alten Reiches*, Mainz, 1986; W. Barta, in: *LÄ* IV, col. 584 ff.; id., “Zur Bedeutung der Opferformel im Alten Reich,” *GM* 96 1987, p. 7 ff.

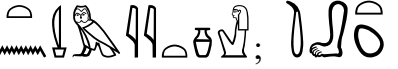
¹² Satzinger, H., *Beobachtungen zur Opferformel: Theorie und Praxis*, *Lingua Aegyptia* 5, 1997, p. 177- 188.

¹³ Warsham, Ch. E., “Reinterpretation of the so- called Bread Loaves in Egyptian offering scenes”, *JARCE* 16, 1979, p. 7- 10.

¹⁴ Nims, Ch., “the Bread and Beer problems of the Mscow Mathematical papyrus”, *JEA* 44, 1958, pp. 56- 65; Grüß, J., *Untersuchung von Broten aus der Ägyptischen Sammlung der staatlichen Museen zu Berlin*, *ZÄS* 68, 1932, p. 79.

¹⁵ Anthony, S., “Baking during the reign of Seti I”, *BIFAO* 86, 1986, p. 307 ff.

White bread t-HD is considered one of the names that indicate the quality of white bread¹⁶, and it is one of the rare names found in the texts of the Old Kingdom, and it was expressed by the triangular-shaped determinative with a pointed top, and its appearance increased in the Middle and New Kingdoms, and this determinative is similar to another determinative of bread names which is  bnb¹⁷, and it often appears in scenes of bread offerings from kings to the gods that they carry this shape in their hands or on a vessel¹⁷.

(d) Hnq(t): Beer which started to appear in the lists of offerings on stele since the second dynasty.  & nmyt: was the goddess of beer in ancient Egypt. It began to appear in the New Kingdom period and continued until the Ptolemaic and Roman period¹⁸. Many texts show its role in the production of beer¹⁹. it also had a role in the production of milk and honey²⁰. Its name was mentioned as an attribute of many goddesses such as: “Nephthys²¹”, and “Hathor²²”.

Beer was a favorite drink of the ancient Egyptians as a regular drink, popular among the public and the elite. Beer was known in ancient Egypt since the Neolithic period, and continued in recorded sources in historical times. It was considered a main drink alongside bread. Unlike most types of modern beer - currently known - beer in ancient Egypt is characterized by being mysterious. It is rich in carbohydrates and sugar that provide food with energy, and is considered an important source of essential fatty acids, amino acids, minerals, and vitamins²³.

Because of the importance of alcoholic beverages in general, they were placed in abundance at banquets, such as wine and beer, and therefore huge vessels, decorated with lotus flowers, containing beverages appear in many tomb scenes. The lively scenes also record the result of men and women enjoying the causes of luxury, as the scenes show some individuals vomiting or fainting after excessive drinking of

¹⁶ Gardiner, A., *AEO* II, A 510; Meeks, *Ann. Lex.*, III, 79. 3329; *Wb*, V, 210 (1- 9); *WPL.*, p. 1116- 1117.

¹⁷ Calverley, A. M., Broome, M. F. and Gardiner, A. H., the Temple of king Sethos I at Abydos, III, pls. 4- 15; Brunner, H., *Die Südlichen Räume des temples von Luxor*, Mainz, 1977, pl. 97; Lacau, P. & Chevrier, H., *Une Chapelle d' Hatshepsout á Karnak*, I, p. 434.

¹⁸ *Wb* V , 312, (13– 14); *WPL*, p. 1146; Helck, *Das Bier im Alten Ägypten*, Berlin, 1971, s. 86 f.; *LGG*, VII, 474.

¹⁹ *Dendara*, II, 216, (10); IX, 173, (14); 237, (4); *Edfou*, I, 76, (2); 114, (2); 142, (3); 151, (7– 8); 241, (9– 10); 365, (15); II, 42, (3); 180, (11); IV, 283, (4).

²⁰ Guglielmi, W., “Tenemu/ Tenemit”, *LÄ* VI, col. 420 .

²¹ *Edfou*, I, 151, (14).

²² *Edfou*, I, 462, (15).

²³ Helck, w., “Bier” in: *LÄ* I, col. 789; Samuel, D., “Beer”, in: *OEAE* I, p. 171.

alcoholic beverages²⁴. Drinking beer leads to drunkenness (drunkenness txt), and thus brings happiness, and helps the deceased to connect with the deities in the afterlife²⁵.

Beer was an important part of the offerings to both gods and the dead. It came directly after bread in traditional funeral offerings. Many vessels containing beer have been found in tombs dating back to different periods. There is a close connection between beer and bread, as both were made at home. Beer was an important economic commodity, perhaps due to its high nutritional value. Beer vessels were often served with various foods. During the Old Kingdom, artworks showing the process of making beer became popular, whether in the form of small statues, such as the statues found in the tomb of "Ni-Kaw-Hathor" or in the form of inscriptions recorded on the walls of tombs²⁶.

(e) Tpy Abd “(the feast of) the month”²⁷, “First of the month festival”, “new crescent day”, the festival of the beginning of the month” or “the lunar day 2”. This monthly festival was celebrated on the first day of the lunar month, when the crescent was new in the sky²⁸. Some scholars have suggested that these monthly feasts were celebrated on the second day of the lunar month on the basis that the day when the moon remained blacked out formed the first day of the Egyptian lunar year, the beginning of the month thus falling on the second day of the lunar month.

(f) smdt or (tpy) smdt “(The feast of) the half-month” was the celebration of the full moon midway through the month. The feast is often translated as “Fifteenth Day Feast”; “fifteenth day of the lunar month”²⁹ According to Eaton this translation could be a sign that the feast of half the month was celebrated according to the civil year, rather than the lunar months³⁰.

Also, the word smdt translated as “lunar day 15”³¹, the two feasts were beneficial occasions on which offerings were made for the deceased as the other monthly feasts,

²⁴ Ikram, S., “Banquets”, in: *OEA I*, p. 164.

²⁵ Wilfong, T. G., “Intoxication”, in: *OEA II*, p. 179.

²⁶ Ikram, S., “Diet”, in: *OEA I*, p. 392; Samuel, D., “Beer”, p. 171.

²⁷ *Wb I*, 65, 8, 10.

²⁸ Eaton, K., “Monthly lunar festivals in the mortuary realm: Historical patterns and symbolic motifs”, *JNES* 70/2, 2011, p. 242.

²⁹ *Wb IV*, 147, 1.

³⁰ Eaton, K., “Monthly lunar festivals in the mortuary realm: Historical patterns and symbolic motifs”, *JNES* 70/2, 2011, 243f.

³¹ Depuydt, L., Civil calendar and lunar calendar in ancient Egypt, 27; The festivals of the month and half month were amongst the most common of the day festivals in Ancient Egypt. They are attested in the feast lists from the Old Kingdom, in the Pyramid Texts (*PT* 324, 373, 438, 468, 483, 532, 610, 684, 690, 720-458, 726,), in Coffin Texts (*CT* 6, 7, 72, 154, 156,

which consist of bread, beer, wine, milk, fruit, birds and vegetables. The benefits for the deceased in celebrating such festivals were rebirth, ascension, and protection³².

One of the texts recorded in the Temple of Edfou indicates that the god Khonsu was the one who created this day with the aim of illuminating the earth, as the text mentions³³:



#nsw qmA .n .f smdt Hr sHD tA m- xt snk

“The god Khonsu created smdt to illuminate the earth after darkness”.

Given the importance of the smdt festival, the goddess Hathor took the title of “Ruler of the smdt festival,” as one of the texts recorded in the Dendera Temple mentions this matter, as follows³⁴:



Dd mdw in @t- Hr xnt Iwnt irt Ra nb(t) pt Hnwt nTrw nb(w) mit nfirt bnrt mrwt nfr(t)
Hr sHb mnDty DfD DfD wDAt nTrt m nTryt

Dd mdw in nTrt tn Spst wsrt ant Hr xnt pr- ant Hr nb(t) psDntyw apr wDAty nb(t)
snwt HqA(t) smdt

"Recitation by Hathor at Dendera, who presides over Dendera, the Eye of Ra, the Lady of Heaven, the Lady of all Gods, the Beautiful Cat, the Sweet of Love, the Beautiful of Face, the Ornament of Eyes, the Human-Eyed of the Eye of the Udjat, the Sacred Eye of the Udjat at Dendera."

277, 253, 316, 318, 474, 480, 695, 723, 1013, 1042, 1151), and also in the Book of the Dead (BD 64 and 162). They often appear at the end of the private feast lists, and when the festival lists were abbreviated, they were usually ignored. Sometimes both of them shared the determinative.

³² Rawash, H. H. & Mohamed, D. M. E., “An offering Basin of  Mr- sw- anx (No. 519/ 1234), in: *JARCH* 28, 2025, P. 186.

³³ *Edfou*, I, 375, 17.

³⁴ *Dendera*, IV, 267, 8- 10.

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"Recitation by this venerable, powerful, beautiful-faced goddess, who presides over Dendera, the lady of the psDntyw³⁵ festival who prepares the eye of the udjat, the lady of the snnw³⁶ festival who rules the smdt³⁷ festival."

There is an important scene in the Temple of Edfu in which the god Thoth appears in a worshipful position before the Eye of Udjat, which symbolizes the moon and which was depicted on top of a column in the shape of a papyrus plant. Thus, this scene indicates the dominance of the full moon over the night sky. The lunar ladder, consisting of 14 steps, appears, and in front of the ladder are 14 gods: the Ennead of Heliopolis, Horus, and the Four Sons of Horus. These gods represent the fourteen days that pass between the birth of the new moon and the full moon. After that come thirty gods representing the days of the lunar month, which begins with the celebration

of the first day of the lunar month, known as  psDntyw.³⁸

There are many sources that refer to celebrations in ancient Egypt, such as the scenes recorded in the temples of Karnak and Luxor. This continued until the Ptolemaic and Roman periods. The recording of celebration scenes was not limited to temples only, as celebration scenes were recorded on the walls of many tombs, as they appeared in the tombs of old kingdom employees among the usual scenes such as agriculture, harvest and sacred journeys. Celebrations appeared abundantly in the New Kingdom in tomb scenes that represent the customs and traditions of celebrations, especially in celebrations related to the beginning of the year, the Valley Festival, Hb- sd Festival and the Harvest Festival³⁹.

Festival lists appeared in many of the tombs of the officials in the New Kingdom in the Theban Necropolis, such as the tomb of Amenemhat  No. TT 48 from the reign of King Amenhotep III, which includes a list of the festivals of Thebes and the Harvest Festival, as it contains a list of the festivals that the dead celebrated in the necropolis and participated in performing some important rituals in it. The most important festivals included in the list are the festivals of the god Amun (the Valley

³⁵ The 1st day of the lunar month: *WPL.*, p. 373- 374; *Wb*, I, 559, 20- 22.

³⁶ It is the name for the sixth day of the lunar month and the festival on that day: *WPL.*, P. 857- 858; *Wb*, IV, 153, 4- 6.

³⁷ El- Kordy, Z., L' Offrande des Fards dans les Temples Ptolémaïques, *ASAE* 68 ,1982, p. 212.

³⁸ Hadeer Kamal, Scenes and Texts of the Northern Wall of the First Hypostyle Hall of the Temple of Edfu (Philological- Cultural study), unpublished MSc., Cairo university, Faculty of Archaeology, 2024, p. 488- 489, (in Arabic).

³⁹ Mansour Elnoubi Mansour, Feast Scenes in the Tombs of the New Kingdom Individuals in the Theban Necropolis: A Comparative Analytical Study, Unpublished PhD Thesis, Assiut University, Faculty of Arts, Sohag, Egyptology Department, 1994, p. 32- 38. (in Arabic).

Festival and the Opet Festival), then the festivals of Osiris and Sokar, the Festival of Hb- sd, and the Harvest Festival. King Amenhotep III participated in these festivals, as some scenes of him appeared in the tomb, as well as his royal titles⁴⁰.

(g) rx/jxt nswt

This title may be translated as royal acquaintance, or custodian of the king's property.⁴¹ Abu Bakr noted that the title may be read as jxt nswt and chose to translate it as royal acquaintance, but he also referred to additional proposals made by scholars of his time, such as 'the one in charge of the king's property', or 'the one who is concerned with the affairs of the king'.⁴²

This title of rank may indicate from his relationship with the pharaoh, especially when it is translated as 'custodian of the king's property',⁴³ or, by using xt as 'cult', in which case, it can be translated in the way suggested by Ron Leprohon, to show that it is referring to 'one connected to the [royal] cult'.⁴⁴

Known to the king or Hasib al-Malik, it is a title that appeared in the era of the Old Kingdom, especially in the era of the Fifth Dynasty, where it appeared for the first time on an offering basin for a woman who belonged to the same family. He was real and then became popular with the senior officials in the two families, 25-26 - including Montumhat, the ruler of Theban, and this title was not honorary, but rather its owner was performing one of the religious functions in the temples.

Comments:

- According to the method of inscription, we can notice that there were two persons inscribed on this object, the skilled one for the upper and the other one for the rest of

⁴⁰ Mansour Elnoubi Mansour, *Feast Scenes in the Tombs of the New Kingdom Individuals in the Theban Necropolis: A Comparative Analytical Study*, p. 115- 116.

⁴¹ Jones, D., *An Index of Ancient Egyptian Titles, Epithets and Phrases of the Old Kingdom*, vol. I, Oxford, 2000, pp. 327-328, n° 1206. For king's acquaintance see Grajetzki, W. , 'Setting a State Anew: The Central Administration from the End of the Old Kingdom to the End of the Middle Kingdom', in *J.-C. Moreno García (ed.), Ancient Egyptian Administration*, *Handbuch der Orientalistik*, I.104, Leiden-Boston: Brill.2013, pp. 241-243
Fischer, H. G., *Egyptian Women of the Old Kingdom and the Heracleopolitan Period*, New York: Metropolitan Museum of Art, 2000, p. 71, n° 176.

⁴² Abu Bakr, A. M., *Excavations at Giza 1949-1950*, Cairo: Government Press, 1953 p. 47.

⁴³ On the title Property Custodian of the King: Jones, D., *An Index of Ancient Egyptian Titles, Epithets and Phrases of the old Kingdom*, vols. I, II, Oxford, *British Archaeological Reports Series* 866 (1), 2000., pp. 327-328, n° 1206; Barta, M., 'The Title 'Property Custodian of the King' during the Old Kingdom Egypt', *ZÄS* 126, 1999, pp. 79-89.

⁴⁴ Friedmann, F. D, Chapter 2: Economic Implications of the Menkaure Triads. In *Towards a New History for the Egyptian Old Kingdom: Perspectives on the Pyramid Age* (Harvard Egyptological Studies). Leiden: Brill Academic Publishers., 2015, pp. 43- 44.

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the text .The following paleographic notes emphasis the last interpretation, that there were two persons who had inscribed this double object and by using two different instruments:

1) The two  m signs in the upper line and lower part are completely different especially in the head, back, tail, and leg. And the two signs in the lower line completely different.

2) The two  x sign in the upper line and lower part are different.

3) The  nsu sign and  r sign in the upper line is bigger than lower line maybe regarding to small space because of libation basin.

4) The  nwb sign in the upper line and lower part have some difference.

5) PtH- Spss was a man's name and can be traced during the Old Kingdom. According to the statement on this basin, it seems likely that Petah Shepses, the son of ꜥst- nwb, was responsible for her burial in the Giza necropolis.

-Such small offering-basins, like this one of ꜥst nwb its function in the funerary rituals has been widely discussed⁴⁵.

-It seems that the double rectangular basins were destined to be containers of water resembling magically a small pool for the benefit of the deceased in the afterlife.

-The double offering basins carved on it indicate that they were, in fact, regarded as miniature lakes, as Junker has long since recognized One in Cairo is decorated with four boats carved in relief, one of them moored on the rim on each side of the basin. Another, in the Louvre, shows four boats on the outer sides of a triple basin, and each boat conveys the deceased owner, who is rowed up and down the lakes within. These four boats correspond exactly to the' four on the other basin, one of which has a prow in the form of a hedgehog. Since the word  means "lake" as well as basin.

- The rims of libation basins were usually inscribed with the names and the titles of the tomb owner or with offering formulae, but there are a few exceptions, like the libation basin of Nekhefti-ka from Giza.⁴⁶

⁴⁵ Junker, H., in: *Archiv Orientalni* 20 ,1952, p. 185ff.; Mostafa, M.M.F. , *Untersuchungen zu Opfertafeln im Alten Reich*, *HÄB* 17,Hildesheim, 1982, pp. 104, 114 f., 116, 124 ff., Pls. XIII, XVII, 1, XVIII, 1, XXIII, 2, XXIV, 1, XXX; H.G. Fischer, in: *MDAIK* 47 1991, p. 127ff., pl. 7a, b; Radwan, A., *The Nun basin of Renpetnefert* ,in : *Egypt and beyond Essays presented to Leonard H.lesko upon his retirement from the Willbour chair of Egyptology at Brown University, Massachusetts*, 2008 pp. 277-283.

Conclusion:

This basin must have been used to present liquid offerings to the owner of the basin, whose name is jst- Nwb “She who is praised of Gold,” which is comparable to masculine examples such as Hsy Ra and by the feminine Hsyt-PtH where the masculine name of the god is preclude.

The son of the owner of this basin was simply depicted and his name “*PtH Spss*” mentioned on it.

It appears that the basin belongs to one of the high priests, and it was a family working in the priesthood. The accuracy of the inscription, the quality of the writing, the refinement of the basin and the quality of the limestone indicate that the deceased owner of the table was one of the distinguished personalities who held an important position namely in the priesthood, and it seems that this basin was placed by the priest's son in the tomb of his mother after her death.

Offering basin are a rectangular shape stones with a depression carved inside them to contain liquids. All basic types of offering stones, tables or basins, had assumed their forms during the Old Kingdom and the style of this offering basin, its hieroglyphs, and its features date it to the end of the Fifth Dynasty.

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⁴⁶ Hölzl, R.,” *Libation Basins from the Old to the New Kingdom*”, 312.

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Unpublished Basin of ꜥst- Nwb from Giza



Photo of the offering basin in the museum of Faculty of Archaeology at Cairo University. (by the author)

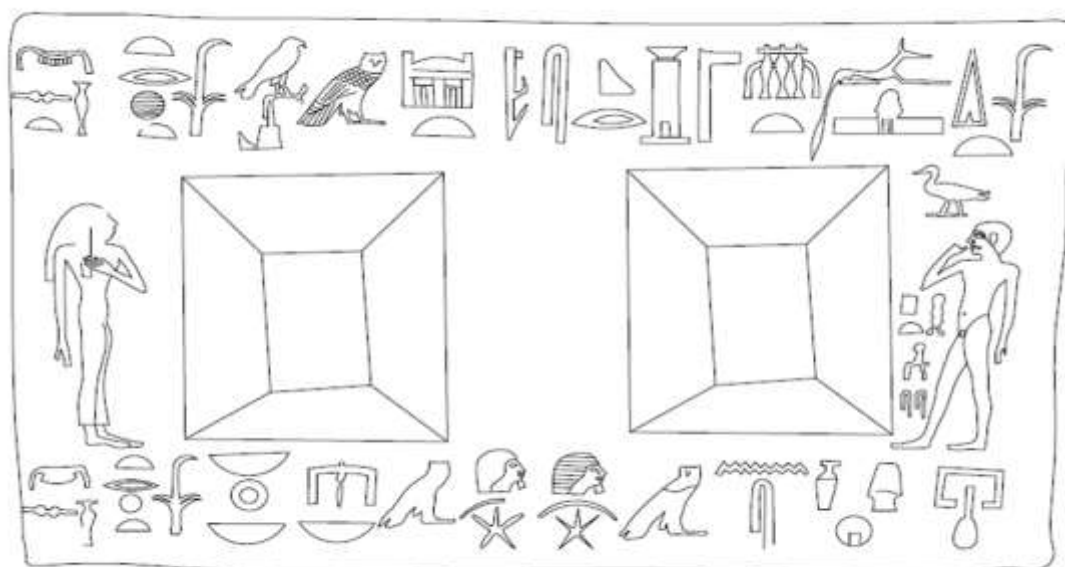


Fig.1 A facsimile of unpublished Basin of ꜥst- Nwb from Giza.